

Boord Notes

Training Guide

How to capture, find and look after farm knowledge on your iPhone.
For Andre and his son.

1. What Boord Notes is for

Boord Notes is a private notebook for farm knowledge: how a job is done, what an odd piece of equipment does, when something needs doing each season. Anything worth handing on goes in, so it is all in one place later.

- **Speak or type.** Dictate with the microphone on your iPhone keyboard, in Afrikaans or English. The app stores only the text, never any audio.
- **Works without signal.** A note saves on the phone first and reaches the server by itself once there is signal again.
- **No sign-in.** The app opens straight onto the Capture screen. Anyone who can reach it can read, edit and archive notes, so keep the phone in the right hands.

A note holds a **title**, the **notes** text, an optional **block / location**, any number of **photos**, and **tags** you choose. It also records where you were and the weather when you first saved it.

2. Setting up the phone (once)

Install to the Home Screen before you capture anything. Notes written in a Safari tab are stored separately from the installed app and will look as if they have vanished. Install first, then always open the app from its icon.

1. Make sure the **Tailscale** app is installed and signed in on the phone.
2. Open the farm's address in **Safari**: `https://<server>.<tailnet>.ts.net:9443/app/` (ask whoever set up the server for the exact link).
3. Tap **Share** (square with an arrow), then **Add to Home Screen**.
4. From now on open **Notes** from its Home Screen icon (Boord crate with a sky-blue leaf).
5. When asked, allow **Location** and **Camera** access.

Both of you use the same link. There is one address and no accounts.

3. Capturing a note

The app opens on **Capture**. The four tabs along the bottom are **Capture**, **Dashboard**, **Entries** and **Settings**.

1. **Title.** Keep it short, e.g. "Irrigation pump quirk".
2. **Block / Location** (optional). Free text, e.g. "Block 4 North" or "near the pump station".
3. **Notes.** Tap the field, then tap the **microphone key** next to the space bar and speak. Tap the keyboard icon or **Done** to stop, then read it over and fix any mistakes.
4. **Tags.** Type a word and press Enter. Existing tags are suggested as you type. You can invent new ones at any time.
5. **Photos.** Tap **Add Photo** and choose **Camera**, **Photo album** or **File**. Photos are shrunk and converted to JPEG on the phone so they send quickly.
6. Tap **Save Note**.

Location and weather

The line above **Save Note** says whether a GPS fix is ready ("Finding your location..." or "No location available"). Saving never waits for it. The **Record GPS location** switch turns this off if you do not want it.

- Location works with no signal. Weather does not, and is left blank rather than filled in later.
- Both are recorded once, when the note is first created. Editing later does not change them.

Tip for dictation in Afrikaans. Add both keyboards in Settings → General → Keyboard → Keyboards. Dictation follows the keyboard that is active, so switch with the globe key.

4. Finding and reviewing notes

Entries

Search by title, notes text or block, and filter by one tag. Tap a note to open it and see the photos, tags, block and full text. Tap the coordinates on a note to open the spot in your phone's map app, handy for walking back to a particular tree.

Dashboard

A quick summary: total notes, notes this week, how many have photos, tags in use, a count per tag, and the latest notes.

Editing and archiving

Button	What it does
Edit	Reopens the note in the Capture form with everything filled in. Location and weather stay as first recorded.
Archive	Hides the note from lists and search. Nothing is erased, but the app has no restore button, so use it only for real mistakes.

5. Working without signal

Every save goes onto the phone first, so it always works. In the background the app then sends notes to the server, and only afterwards their photos. It retries about every 10 seconds and straight away when signal returns. You do nothing.

- A badge such as **"2 not yet synced"** shows near the top while notes wait. It normally clears on its own.
- Do not leave unsynced notes for days. If the app sits unused for about a week, iOS can clear its storage and anything not yet synced is lost. After a run of offline notes, open the app somewhere with signal.

6. Backups

The server makes a full backup (notes and photos) every night at 02:00 and keeps the latest 14. It is skipped if the PC is off at that time.

To make one yourself: **Settings** → **Backups** → **Backup Now**. The button shows "Backing up..." until done. Each backup in the list has a **Download** link.

Message	Meaning
Backup created	Done. The new backup is at the top of the list.
Backup failed - can't reach the server	Check Tailscale and that the server is running.
Backup failed on the server (500)	The server was reached but the backup failed, most often a full disk. Ask whoever looks after the PC.
Backup timed out	It may still be finishing. Wait a minute and check the list before trying again.

Now and then, copy the latest backup off the server (cloud drive or USB stick). Backups on the same PC do not protect against that PC's disk failing.

7. When something goes wrong

Problem	What to do
"Not yet synced" will not clear	Swipe the app away in the app switcher and reopen it from its icon. If it persists, check Tailscale is connected and the address loads in Safari.
Add Photo does nothing, or Camera fails	Open the app from the Home Screen icon on the <code>https</code> address. As a fallback, take the photo in the normal Camera app and attach it with Photo album .
No location on a note	Open from the Home Screen icon. Check Settings → Privacy & Security → Location Services is on and allowed "While Using". Go outdoors and wait a few seconds. The note saves either way.
Location but no weather	Normal when the note was made without signal. Blank means "not known".
Dictation types the wrong language	Switch keyboard with the globe key, and confirm both keyboards are added.
A note vanished after installing the icon	It was captured in a Safari tab before installing and cannot be moved across. Re-enter it in the installed app.
App looks normal but everything fails (old : 8443 icon)	Delete the icon, remove the server from Safari → Settings → Advanced → Website Data, then re-add the icon from the : 9443 address.

Quick reference

- ☐ Installed to the Home Screen and opened only from the icon
- ☐ Location and Camera allowed
- ☐ Both Afrikaans and English keyboards added
- ☐ Title, notes, block and tags filled in, then **Save Note**
- ☐ Opened the app with signal after a batch of offline notes
- ☐ Check that "not yet synced" has cleared
- ☐ Copy a backup off the server every so often